

Theme: Speech
Week:
Date:, 2026.
Class: SS 1
Period:
Time:
Duration:
Subject: English Language
Unit topic: Speech
Lesson topic: Oral Argument/Debate.
Specific (behavioural) objectives: At the end of the lesson, students should be able to:

- i. Briefly explain what debate is.
- ii. Identify the structure of a debate.
- iii. Identify the current trends in debate.
- iv. Make (write) debate on a chosen topic.

Instructional resource: a banner showing opening greeting (vocatives).

Lesson presentation

Step 1: IDENTIFICATION OF PRIOR IDEAS.

Teacher asks students on what they understand about the day's lesson topic.

Mode: a couple of students.

Teacher's activities: teacher asks students the following questions:

- i. What is a debate?
- ii. How would recognize a debate question?
- iii. List three rules guiding debate.
- iv. Can you mention one new trend in debate?

Students' activities: students respond to the questions asked based on their knowledge of the topic.

Step 2: EXPLORATION.

Mode: entire class.

Teacher's activities: Teacher guides the students to explain what debate is and cite an example of a debate question.

What a debate?

Debate is an argument that is orally presented. In other words, debate is an oral argument.

Example of debate question includes, "It is better to attend the school that is near your environment than the one outside your environment."

Students' activities: the students listen and read a passage.

Step 3: DISCUSSION.

Mode: entire class.

Teacher's activities: the teacher guides the students to identify the structure of a debate and the new trends in debate.

The structure of a debate

The following is the structure of a debate:

1) Introduction (one paragraph):

- (a) Opening greetings (vocatives): study your environment to know those present and greet them appropriately: example,

Mr. Chairman, Panel of Judges, the Moderator, Accurate Time Keeper, Co-debaters, My Fellow Students, Ladies and Gentlemen.

- (b) Introduce yourself: example, my name is Abiola Abiodun.

- (c) Mention your stand in the motion you are debating on. Example, I am here to propose the motion that states, "It is better to attend school that is near your environment than the one outside of your environment" with the following points backing up my argument.

- (d) Define key words if necessary. Example, before I proceed, permit me to define some key words, ...

2) The body paragraph (three paragraphs). The body provides detail in support of your stand in the argument:

- (a) Give your reasons to support your stand.

- (b) Counter your opponent's points. Imagine the points your opponent is like to raise. Raise each of these points and tell your audience that it is wrong, you can then go ahead and place your opinions upon the one you have disapproved. Example, some people may say, without doctors sick people will die because there will be none to treat them medically. But if I may ask, will there be doctors without teachers, in fact, the greatest sickness in life is ignorant, which can only be cured by teachers and not doctors...

3) The conclusion (one paragraph). This should comprise the following:

- (a) Call on all present by their names. Example, the Chairman, Distinguished Guests, Fellow Students, Ladies and Gentlemen, and

- (b) Conclude by saying, I believe with these points of mine, you will agree with me that "It is better to attend the school that is near your environment than the one outside your environment." Thank you.

New trends (parliamentary) in debate

Co-debater - Friends in argument.

I am here to support the motion that states – in this house we agree that...

I am here to oppose the motion that states – in this house we disagree that...

You can raise point of information.

You can use newspaper (or any literature) and electronic devices like projector to support your argument.

Students' activities: students listen attentively, participate in the discussion and take note.

Step 4: APPLICATION.

Mode: group.

Teacher's activities: the teacher divides the class into groups 'A' and 'B' and engages in a debate competition for about ten minutes to test their understanding of the day's lesson topic:

Class activity:

Propose or oppose the motion that states "It is better to attend the school that is near your environment than the one outside your environment." State the figure of speech used in the following and their meaning:

Students' activities: students carry out the class activity in their note books.

Step 5: EVALUATION.

Mode: a couple of students.

Teacher's activities: the teacher asks students the following questions:

- i. Briefly explain what debate is.
- ii. Identify the structure of a debate.
- iii. Identify the current trends in debate.
- iv. Present the right vocatives for a debate.

Students' activities: the students respond to the questions asked.

ASSIGNMENT: students are to write to propose or oppose the motion that states "It is better to attend the school that is near your environment than the one outside your environment."

REFERENCE MATERIALS

Oxford English Language Course Book 1.

F. Ademola-Adeoye et al(2012). New Concept English for Senior Secondary Schools, Book 1, Learn Africa Plc, Lagos. Pages 203-204.

Capacity Building Workshop, 2017, Karu Centre.

